Product Requirement Document: GeForce NOW Referral Campaign

Document Status: Draft **Target Release:** 8 Weeks (4 Sprints)

Epic: Growth, User Acquisition, and Retention

Target Audience: Engineering, Design, Marketing, Stakeholders

Executive Summary

The GeForce NOW (GFN) Referral Campaign aims to empower current users to share a unique invite link with their network. When a new user subscribes using this link, both parties are rewarded. The advocate earns "Stamps" that contribute to milestone unlocks, while the referred user receives an immediate incentive. To handle the complexity of GFN's pricing tiers, we are introducing an abstracted "Stamp System" to track campaign progression. This feature requires dashboard UI updates, gamified progress tracking, secure attribution logic, and basic admin tools for oversight.

Problem Statement

- **High CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost):** Traditional paid media acquisition is becoming more expensive.
- **Possible churn increase from the price surge**: To create a countermeasure for the price increase expected during 1st of July and 1st August,
- **Untapped Word-of-Mouth:** GFN has highly satisfied users who recommend the service, but we currently have no systemic way to track, incentivize, or capitalize on this organic sharing.

Business Objectives & KPIs

- **Primary Metric:** Number of net-new paid subscriptions generated via referral links.
- **Secondary Metric (K-Factor / Viral Coefficient):** The average number of successful referrals generated per active Advocate.
- **Secondary Metric (Conversion Rate):** Percentage of users who click a referral link and successfully complete checkout.
- **Tertiary Metric:** LTV (Life Time Value) and retention rate of referred users compared to organically acquired users.

User Stories (high-level)

- **As a GFN advocate**, I want to share my unique link with friends so that I can earn stamps toward free GFN playtime, free monthly plans, or third-party rewards.
- **As a new referred user**, I want to receive an automatic discount at checkout so that I feel immediately rewarded for using my friend's link.
- **As a GFN product admin**, I want to access an internal dashboard to manually adjust stamps and view logs so that I can resolve customer support tickets efficiently.

1. The Advocate (Existing GFN Subscriber)

Story 1.1: Discovery & Link Generation *As an Advocate, I want to easily find my referral link in my dashboard so that I can start sharing it immediately without hunting through menus.*

Acceptance Criteria:

A new "Refer a Friend" tab is permanently (tentative on the campaign period) visible within the dashboard section

The UI includes a one-click "Copy Link" button that briefly changes to "Copied!" when clicked.

Story 1.2: Progress Tracking (The Gamification Loop) *As an Advocate, I want to see a visual representation of my earned Stamps and upcoming milestones so that I know exactly how close I am to my next reward.*

Acceptance Criteria:

The dashboard features a "Stamp Book" UI showing current stamped slots and empty slots.

The UI clearly indicates the threshold for the next milestone (e.g., "Only 3 more Stamps until your Free Ultimate Month!").

Stamp balances update dynamically based on the backend ledger.

Story 1.3: Reward Redemption (Phase 1) *As an Advocate, I want to easily claim my reward once I hit a milestone so that I can use my free playtime or free monthly playtime.*

Acceptance Criteria:

When a milestone is reached, a "Claim Reward" button becomes active (ungreyed).

Clicking "Claim Reward" opens a modal displaying the alphanumeric promo code.

The system automatically triggers an email to the user's registered address containing the same code and redemption instructions.

2. The Referred User (Prospective Subscriber)

Story 2.1: The Landing Experience *As a Referred User, I want to see confirmation that my friend's link worked when I hit the website so that I feel confident I will get my discount.*

Acceptance Criteria:

Clicking the referral link drops a 30-day tracking cookie.

The GFN subscription landing page displays a dynamic banner reading: *"You've unlocked a special referral discount! Select a plan below."*

Story 2.2: Frictionless Checkout *As a Referred User, I want the discount applied automatically at checkout so that I don't have to manually type in a promo code.*

Acceptance Criteria:

The Stripe checkout payload reads the referral cookie/hash.

A 10% discount is automatically applied to the cart total.

The discount is clearly visible as a distinct line item (e.g., `Referral Promo: -60 THB`).

The checkout "Terms & Conditions" explicitly states that promotional referral purchases are non-refundable. (tentative)

3. The Customer Support Admin

Story 3.1: Audit & Investigation *As a CS Admin, I want to search a user's account and view their complete point history so that I can investigate claims in case of missing Stamps.*

Acceptance Criteria:

The internal Admin Panel includes a "Referral Ledger" search function.

Admins can search by Advocate Email or User ID.

The ledger displays an immutable list of all point grants, deductions, and reward claims with exact UTC timestamps.

Story 3.2: Manual Overrides *As a CS Admin, I want to manually add or remove Stamps from a user's account so that I can fix tracking bugs or penalize users abusing the system.*

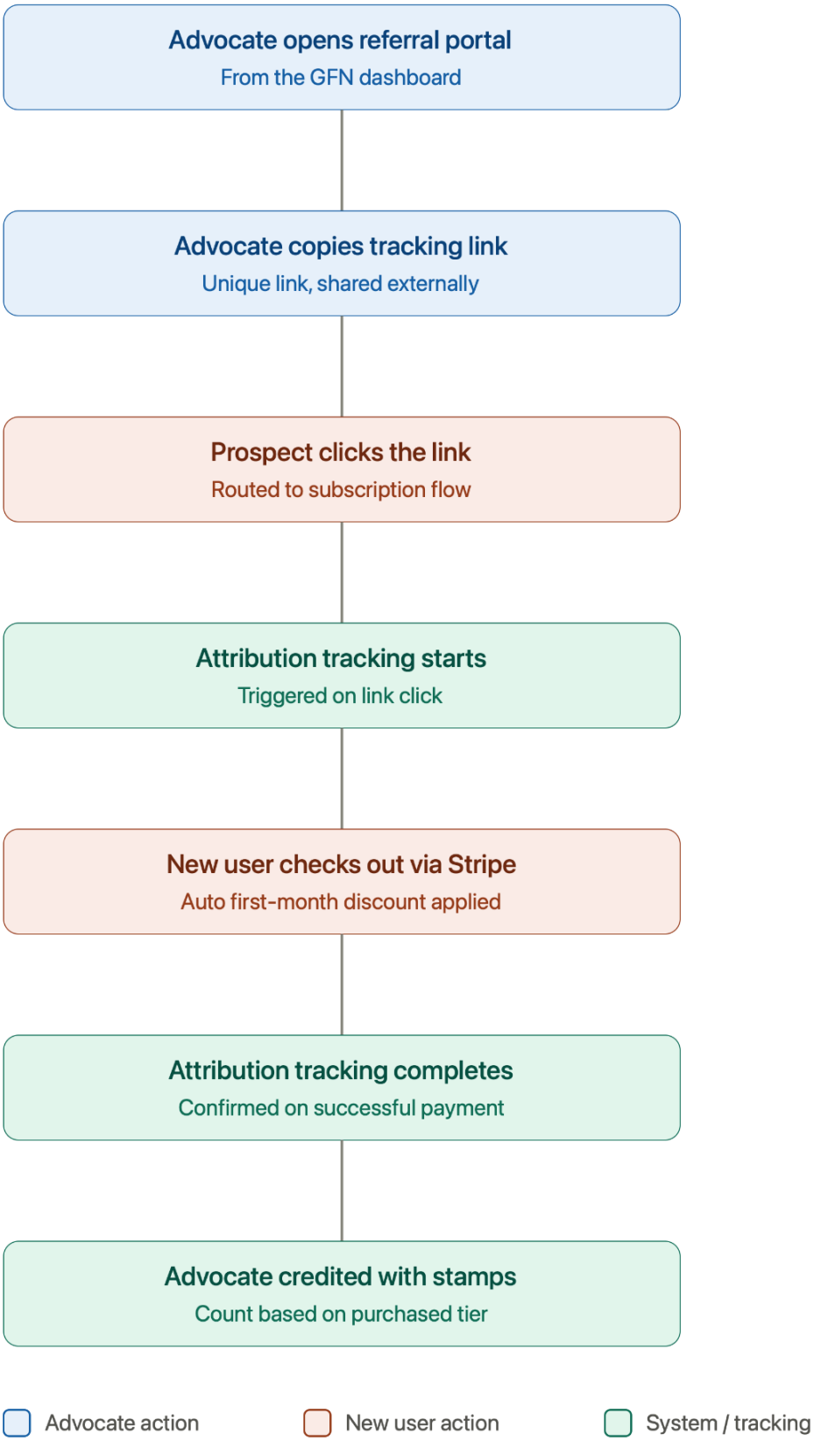
Acceptance Criteria:

Admins have access to `[+ Add]` and `[- Remove]` Stamp buttons.

Executing a manual adjustment requires the Admin to select a "Reason Code" from a dropdown.

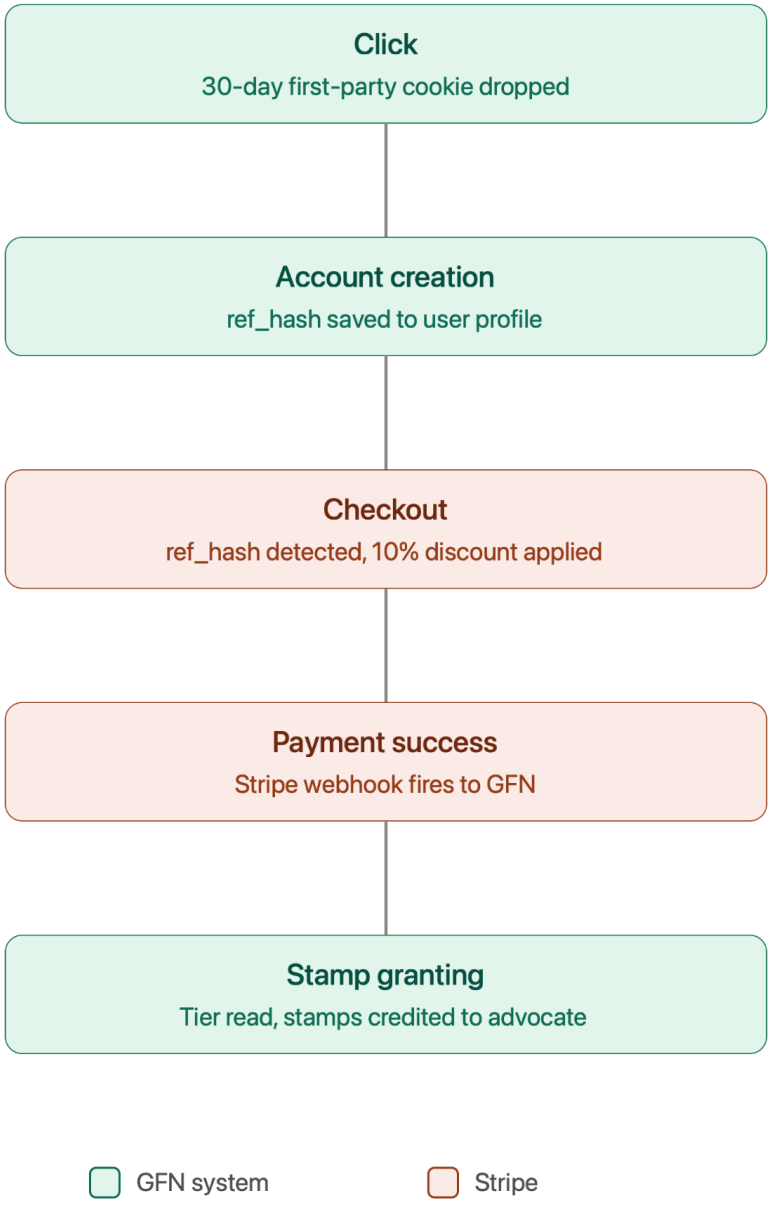
Executing a manual adjustment requires the Admin to input a valid Customer Support Ticket Number (e.g., Zendesk ID) to complete the action.

User Flow


Advocate opens referral portal
From the GFN dashboard
Advocate copies tracking link
Unique link, shared externally
Prospect clicks the link
Routed to subscription flow
Attribution tracking starts
Triggered on link click
New user checks out via Stripe
Auto first-month discount applied
Attribution tracking completes
Confirmed on successful payment
Advocate credited with stamps
Count based on purchased tier
Advocate action
New user action
System / tracking

1. The advocate accesses the new Referral Campaign portal within their GFN dashboard.
2. The advocate generates and copies their unique tracking link to share externally.
3. A prospective new user clicks the link and is directed to the GFN subscription flow.
4. Attribution tracking initiates upon link click.
5. The new user completes the checkout process via Stripe, receiving an automatic first-month discount.
6. Attribution tracking completes upon successful payment.
7. The system credits the advocate's account with the appropriate number of stamps based on the purchased tier.

Tracking & Attribution (The Funnel)



1. **Click:** Referred user clicks the link. The system drops a first-party cookie valid for 30 days.
2. **Account Creation:** User creates an NVIDIA account. The `ref_hash` is appended to their user profile database entry.
3. **Checkout:** User enters Stripe checkout. The system detects the `ref_hash` and automatically applies the "Phase 1: 10% Discount" line item.
4. **Payment Success:** Stripe webhook fires back to GFN.

5. **Stamp Granting:** GFN backend reads the purchased tier, calculates the correct Stamp value, and credits the Advocate's account.

Campaign Eligibility

Eligibility determines which referred users can trigger a stamp-earning conversion. This section defines who qualifies in Phase 1 and flags a segment that needs further discussion before launch.

Eligible: Net-New Users (Phase 1 Launch Scope) — At launch, the referral link only validates for users who have never held a paid GFN subscription on their account, at any point in the account's history. This is the strictest and safest definition of "new user" and avoids any ambiguity around partial trials, lapsed plans, or legacy pricing tiers.

- Eligibility check happens at the point of checkout, not at link click or account creation, since a user's subscription history is the determining factor.
- If an ineligible user (i.e. one with prior paid history) completes checkout via a referral link, the checkout itself is not blocked — they can still subscribe normally — but no referral discount is applied and no stamp is generated for the advocate.
- This rule is consistent with the Strictly Net-New Users requirement under Fraud Prevention & Edge Cases.

Future Feature: Returnees Users - returnee users who previously held a paid GFN subscription but have since cancelled or expired— are excluded from Phase 1 eligibility, but represent a meaningful untapped segment. This group is called out separately because their inclusion raises questions that the Phase 1 mechanics aren't yet designed to answer.

Core Mechanics: The Stamp Book System

Because GFN offers different subscription tiers (Performance vs. Ultimate) and varied durations (1-month, 6-month, 12-month), tying rewards directly to exact currency spent is complex. The solution is an abstracted Stamp System. Stamps are awarded based on the commitment level of the new user.

> **Note:** To determine the exact profitability of the stamp issue, Marketing must evaluate the Cost Per Acquisition (CPA) and the Lifetime Value (LTV) gain from the referral to finalize the stamp's monetary equivalent prior to launch.
>
> Please refer to this document

Plan Tier	Duration	Stamps
Performance	1 Month	1 Stamp
Performance	6 Months	5 Stamps
Performance	12 Months	10 stamps
Ultimate	1 Month	2 Stamps
Ultimate	6 Months	10 Stamps
Ultimate	12 Months	15 Stamps

Referral Link Generation

- **Requirement:** Every active GFN user will automatically have a unique referral hash generated for their account, accessible via their dashboard.
- **Format:** `member.bro.game/sign-up/referral?ref=[unique_hash]`
- **Sharing Capabilities:** The UI must include a one-click "Copy Link" button, alongside integrations to easily share the link on preferred social media platforms.

Fraud Prevention & Edge Cases

Referral programs are highly susceptible to abuse. The following rules must be strictly enforced at the backend level to protect business revenue:

- **Self-Referral Blocks:** The system must block stamp generation if the referred user account shares the exact same IP address at the time of purchase, or utilizes a payment method (Credit Card, Debit Card and other payment methods) previously used by the advocate's account.

- **Strictly Net-New Users:** The referral link will only validate for users who have never held a paid GFN subscription. (this would be hard for Stripe logic)
- **Terms & Conditions:** The checkout page T&Cs must be updated to explicitly state the rules of the referral program, reserving the right to ban accounts found manipulating the reward system.
- **Non-refundable if opt-in the referral program:** this is the easiest way to prevent any refunds that might eventually happen within the campaign loop.
- **Idempotency cases:** need to figure out what would happen when a user has a duplicate referral link interacted.

Gamification & User Interface

To drive continuous engagement, the advocate dashboard must visually celebrate progress.

- **The Stamp Book:** A digital booklet UI where earned stamps are visually stamped into empty slots.
- **Progress Bar:** A linear track showing the user's journey toward the next major milestone.
- **Reward Previews:** Locked icons showing what happens at 5, 10, or 20 stamps to incentivize continued sharing.

Reward Progression (Milestones) tentative

Stamps accumulate to unlock tiered rewards. Exact values are to be tuned by Product Marketing prior to launch, but the system must support the following structure:

(need to discuss further about the reward experience for the users, they can be in whatever format as long as the users can see the progressions and redeem the price as they hit the mile stone)

Milestone Level	Stamp Requirement	Proposed Reward
Milestone 1	2 Stamps	Small Perk (e.g., 5 Free Top-Up Hours)
Milestone 2	5 Stamps	Medium Perk (e.g., 1 Free Month of Ultimate)
Milestone 3	10+ Stamps	High-Value Perk (e.g., $10 Steam Wallet Code or Xbox Gamepass 1-Month Code, sourced via Shopify library integration)

System Logging & Internal Admin Tools

To ensure system integrity, financial accountability, and proper customer support enablement, the backend must maintain an immutable ledger of all point/stamp transactions.

The Point Ledger System: The system must log and keep track of every single point/stamp issued, redeemed, or revoked. This log cannot be hard-deleted (append-only or soft-delete only for auditing purposes). Each log entry must capture the following metadata at a minimum:

- **Transaction ID:** A unique string for the specific point issuance.
- **Timestamp:** Exact date and time (UTC) the points were granted.
- **Advocate ID:** The user receiving the points.
- **Referred ID:** The new user whose purchase triggered the points.
- **Trigger Event:** What caused the issuance (e.g., `Ultimate_1Month_Purchase`, `Manual_CS_Adjustment`, `Reward_Redemption`).
- **Point Value:** The number of stamps added (e.g., `+2`) or deducted (e.g., `-10`).
- **Status:** Pending (in refund window), Vested (ready to use), or Revoked (fraud detected).

Customer Support (CS) Tools:

- **Audit Logging:** A searchable database interface detailing every stamp issued per user.
- **Manual Override Interface:** A secure dashboard allowing authorized CS agents to manually add or subtract stamps from a user's profile to resolve disputes

Phase Rollout Breakdown

Phase 1: MVP (Initial Launch)

- **Audience:** GeForce NOW Powered by bro.game users.
- **Advocate Reward Fulfillment:** Manual Code Redemption. Users click "Claim" in their dashboard and receive a generated promo code sent directly to their email address.
- **Referred Reward Fulfillment:** Instant checkout discount applied automatically via Stripe at the time of initial purchase. (or unique discount code generated for each advocate?)

Phase 2: V2 (Always-On System - Future Scope)

- **Audience:** GeForce NOW Powered by bro.game users (with potential expansion to Alliance Partners).
- **Advocate Reward Fulfillment:** Instant Provisioning. The backend automatically credits GFN playtime/months to the user's account without requiring manual code entry.
- **Target Expansion:** Target "Lapsed/Returnee" users, featuring new missions and rewards specifically designed for bringing back old players.

Extra Ideas:
100 stamps for 1 year Ultimate?

Problems to solve later on

โควตาของรางวัลจำกัดต่อเดือนไหม? หรือแจกได้ไม่อั้นจนกว่าจะจบแคมเปญ?

- *Pending 14? —> pending 15 mai*
- หากเกิดเหตุการณ์อัปเกรด/down grade แผน ระหว่างนั้น เราจะนับ stamp จากแค่ตอนซื้อครั้งแรกใช่มั้ย
- จำกัดจำนวนเพื่อนสูงสุดที่แนะนำได้ต่อวัน/ต่อบัญชีหรือไม่

NEW

- **สมมติว่าB เป็นผู้ใช้ใหม่ วันแรกเปิด Link ของคนที่ 1**

แต่อีก 5 วันต่อมา นาย B ดันไปกด Link แนะนำของ คนที่ 2 แล้วตัดสินใจกดซื้อแพ็กเกจทันทีผ่านช่องทาง PromptPay แบบนี้คือให้คนหลังใช่มั้ย

Solution - issue the payout only if the user converts (checkout)